PANCRELIPASE

With every meal & snack

Fibrosing colonopathy at high doses

CHEMICAL NAME Porcine pancreatic enzymes: lipase, protease and amylase (pancreatin)

CLASS Pancreatic enzyme replacement therapy (PERT)

TRADE NAMES Creon · Pancrease · Zenpep · Nutrizym

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Exocrine pancreatic insufficiency: cystic fibrosis, chronic pancreatitis, pancreatectomy, pancreatic cancer.
- Steatorrhoea and malabsorption due to pancreatic insufficiency.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Supplies **lipase** (fat), **protease** (protein) and **amylase** (starch) → digestion and absorption of nutrients and fat-soluble vitamins.

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** capsules with the first bite of every meal and snack (or split during long meals).
- Swallow whole; if difficulty, open and mix granules with acidic soft food (apple purée) — do not crush or chew granules.
- Drink fluid with dose; do not mix with milk/alkaline foods.
- Doses expressed in lipase units.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Abdominal pain, bloating, nausea.
- Constipation or diarrhoea.
- Perioral and perianal irritation (if chewed/excess).

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Fibrosing colonopathy (very high doses, children with CF).
- Hyperuricaemia, hyperuricosuria.
- Allergy to pork proteins.

DOSAGES

- **Adult start:** 25,000–50,000 lipase units with meals, half with snacks; titrate to symptoms.
- **Children (CF):** 1,000–2,500 lipase units/kg per meal (infants: about 4,000 units per 120 mL formula or breastfeed, US label).
- Max 10,000 lipase units/kg/day (fibrosing colonopathy).

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Pork protein hypersensitivity (relative).
- Acute pancreatitis or acute exacerbation of chronic pancreatitis (early).

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **Acarbose, miglitol:** ↓ effect.
- **PPIs/H2 blockers:** may improve efficacy (less acid inactivation).

PHARMACOKINETICS

- Enteric-coated microspheres release enzymes in duodenum (pH >5.5).
- Not absorbed; digested and excreted in faeces.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Give at the start of meals; check timing with feeds.
- Monitor stool frequency, oily/floating stools, weight, growth (children).
- Monitor fat-soluble vitamin levels (A, D, E, K).
- Teach correct opening/mixing of capsules.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Take with every meal and snack containing fat.
- Do not chew the beads.
- Report abdominal pain, bloating or changes in stool.
- Note: product comes from pig pancreas.

KEY POINTS

- Pancreatic enzymes; lipase units.
- Never chew granules.
- Take with first bite of food.
- Max 10,000 lipase units/kg/day.

SOURCES CHECKED [578] Pertzye, oral (US label) [579] Creon, oral (US label)

Full references p. 432–457